them, which Mathur thought was merely a gesture to show that the USA was concerned about terrorist activities in Punjab.

As early as 1971, USA-based R&AW operatives informed the Indian government about increasing activities by the Khalistan movement in the North American continent. These notes were shared with the domestic spy agency, the Intelligence Bureau (IB), which was watching extremists within the country. On 12 October 1971, The New York Times carried a half page advertisement captioned 'The Sikhs demand an independent state in India—the only guarantee for peace in the subcontinent.' On 13 October, a R&AW agent sent a coded report to New Delhi. The R&AW note said:

The Advertisement was issued under the name of Dr. Jagjit Singh Chohan, Former Finance Minister of Punjab and General Secretary Shiromani Akali Dal, whose address was given as Hotel Commodore, New York. The advertisement after tracing the history of the Sikhs alleged: A planned racist offensive against Sikhs has been in operation. Their religious places have been defiled and taken.' It further announced that a demonstration would be held in front of the United Nations on Wednesday October 13, 1971 at 11 AM. One Surjit Singh Bhullar from London now on a visit to New York is reported to be working actively for the purpose. He is reported to have promised to incur all expenses in this regard. He further said that just as India was supporting Bangladesh Movement, Pakistan would support their de

mand for an independent nation. Further details are awaited.

The spies watched Chohan and the proposed demonstration. On 14 October 1971, they told New Delhi that it had been a flop. Only half a dozen Sikhs were visible outside the United Nations